UNIVERSITY OF COPENHAGEN



Københavns Universitet





Exploring the needs for developing educational materials to strengthen inclusive care for LGBTQIA+ individuals in community pharmacies

Panagopoulou, Anna; Sørensen, Janne; Jacobsen, Ramune

Published in:
Pharmacy Education

DOI:
10.46542/pe.2026.262.127

Publication date:
2026

Document version
Publisher's PDF, also known as Version of record

Citation for published version (APA):
Panagopoulou, A., Sørensen, J., & Jacobsen, R. (2026). Exploring the needs for developing educational materials to strengthen inclusive care for LGBTQIA+ individuals in community pharmacies. *Pharmacy Education*, *26*(2), 12-12. https://doi.org/10.46542/pe.2026.262.127

Download date: 07. Nov. 2026

EXPLORING THE NEEDS FOR DEVELOPING EDUCATIONAL MATERIALS TO STRENGTHEN INCLUSIVE CARE FOR LGBTQIA+ INDIVIDUALS IN COMMUNITY PHARMACIES

Panagopoulou, A.; Sørensen, J.; Jacobsen, R.
Correspondence: ramune.jacobsen@sund.ku.dk
University of Copenhagen

Background
Growing population diversity, including increased recognition of LGBTQIA+ communities, places new demands on healthcare systems. In Denmark, research on LGBTQIA+ individuals' healthcare experiences remains limited, particularly regarding pharmaceutical care. Additionally, Danish pharmacy programs lack structured education and guidance on communicating with and supporting LGBTQIA+ individuals. This study examines experiences, practices, and knowledge gaps among LGBTQIA+ individuals, pharmacy students, and community pharmacy staff to inform the development of educational materials and practical guidance for more inclusive pharmacy practice.

Methods
The Design Thinking model guides the development of innovative educational initiatives, emphasizing Empathize, Define, and Ideate phases (1). In the Empathize phase, qualitative interviews with six LGBTQIA+ individuals explored experiences and needs related to pharmaceutical care. In the Define phase, two focus groups with pharmacy students and professionals will examine their perspectives, preparedness, and challenges when interacting with LGBTQIA+ individuals. In the Ideate phase, students, professionals, and LGBTQIA+ individuals will participate in a co-creation workshop to generate ideas to enhance pharmacists' education and support more inclusive pharmacy practice.

Results
Interviewed LGBTQIA+ individuals viewed Denmark's public healthcare as accessible, though experiences with doctors' competence, preparedness, and understanding of transition-related needs varied. Pharmacy services were viewed positively, but pharmacists' knowledge about transition procedures and treatments was perceived as outdated. Key challenges stemmed from institutional rigidity: binary classification systems and lengthy evaluation procedures, prompting some to seek care abroad. In pharmacies, limited privacy during dispensing and counter-based counseling was noted as problematic. Participants emphasized the need for improved education, empathy, and practical diversity competence training, particularly concerning inclusive and sensitive language.
The results of the focus groups and co-creation workshop will be presented at the conference.

Conclusions
The findings so far indicate a need for enhanced provider competence, inclusive communication, and structural improvements to ensure pharmaceutical care meets the needs of LGBTQIA+ individuals.

References

(1) Nørgaard, L. S., Møllebæk, M., Halstrøm, P. L., Riis, N. L. F., Christensen, V. B., & Cantarero Arevalo, L. (2021). Using real-world cases, innovation and rhetorical tools to teach social pharmacy. *Pharmacy Education*, *21*(1), 555-568. https://doi.org/10.46542/pe.2021.211.555568

UNIVERSITY OF COPENHAGEN
DEPARTMENT OF PHARMACY

Exploring the needs for developing educational materials to strengthen inclusive care for LGBTQIA+ individuals in community pharmacies

Anna Panagopoulou [2]*, Janne Sørensen[1] and Ramune Jacobsen[2]
1. Research Center for Migration, Ethnicity and Health, Department of Health Services Research, University of Copenhagen
2. Research group for Social and Clinical Pharmacy, Department of Pharmacy, University of Copenhagen
* Correspondence to tml687@sund.ku.dk, LinkedIn QR code:

Introduction

- **Denmark is one of the most LGBTQIA+ friendly countries in Europe. However, health disparities still occur.**
- **Limited research in Denmark on LGBTQIA+ individuals' experiences and needs regarding pharmacy practise.**
- **Lack of LGBTQIA+ structured education and competency training for pharmacy staff in Denmark.**
- **Lack of pharmacy staff insights on educational needs in serving LGBTQIA+ people.**

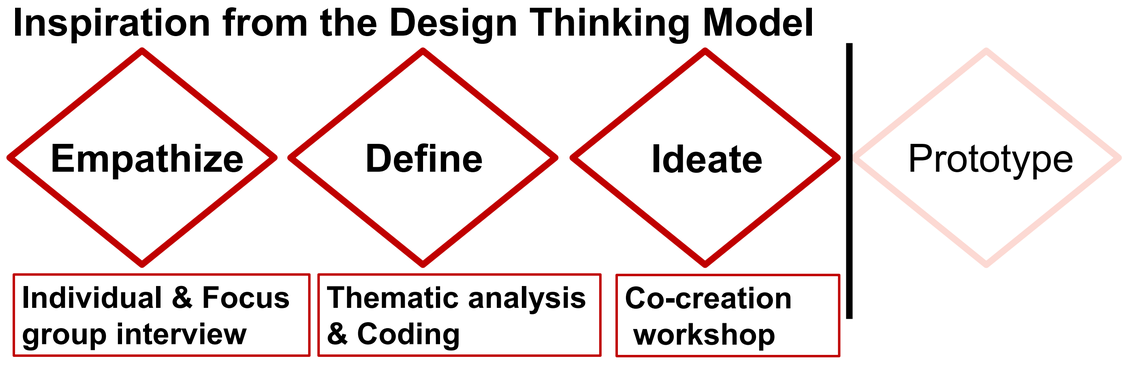


Aims

1. **Understand LGBTQIA+ community experiences and needs in pharmacy practice.**
2. **Examine pharmacy staff's experiences and learning needs for inclusive care.**
3. **Integrate perspectives from both groups to generate proposals for developing inclusive pharmacy education materials.**

Methods

Inspiration from the Design Thinking Model



3-phased research project

6 Individual interviews with LGBTQIA+ people

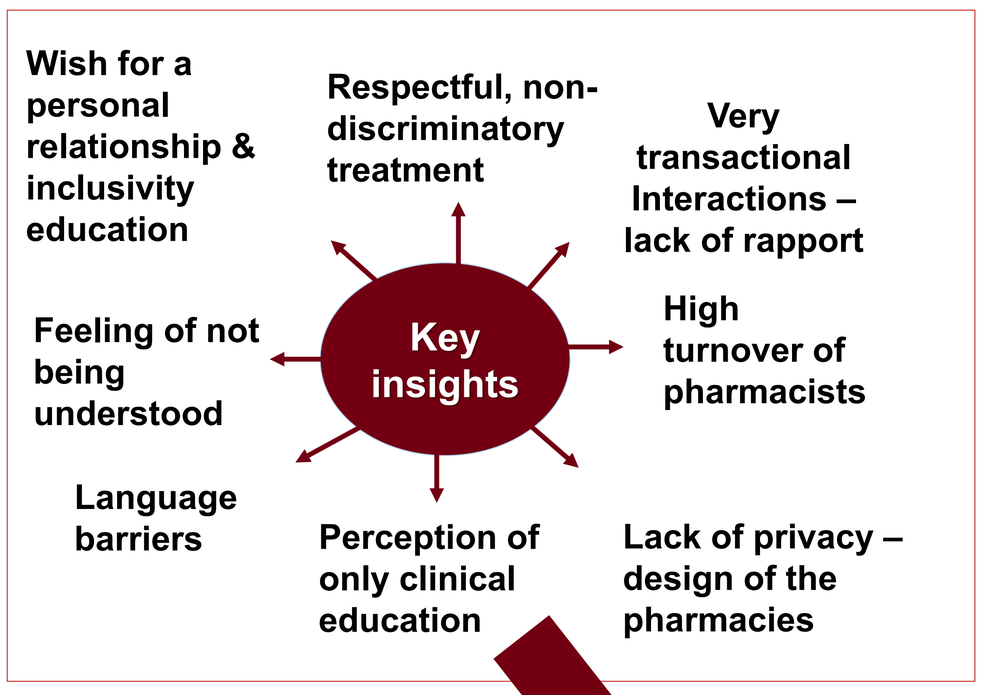
1 focus group interview with pharmacy staff (3 participants)

1 co-creation workshop with both stakeholder groups

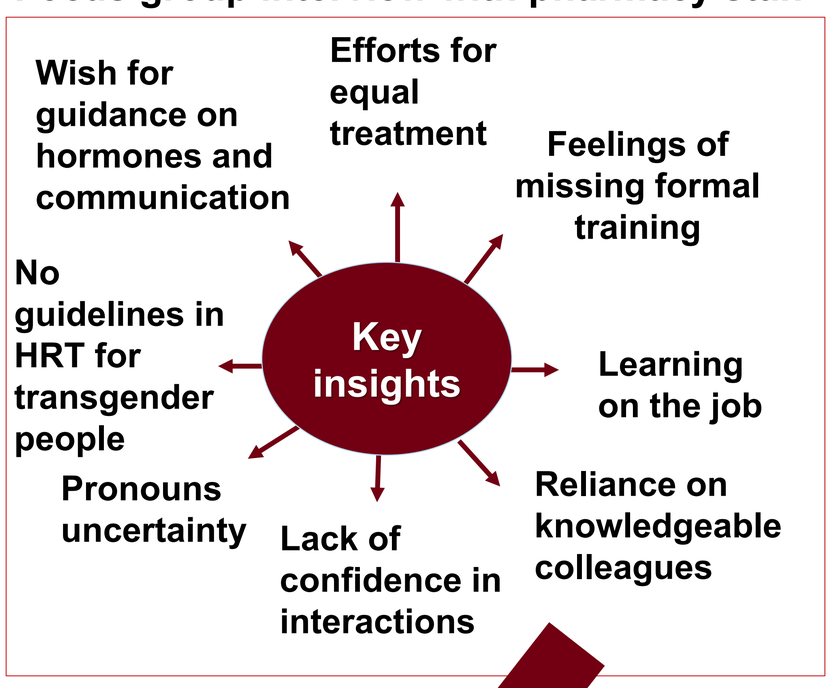
Semi-structured interviews analyzed using thematic analysis

Results

interviews with LGBTQIA+ people living in Denmark



Focus group interview with pharmacy staff

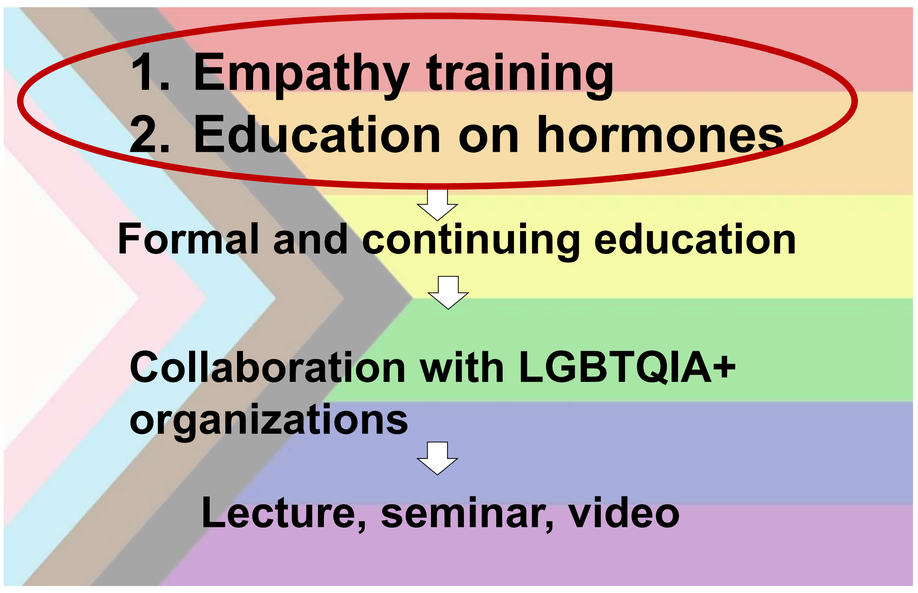


"You're more educated on the impact of the drugs, like the interactions between the drugs themselves, but not necessarily on the human side of it, right?" (transgender, non-binary person)

"They could also invite a speaker from the community to help explain what it is like to go to the pharmacy as an LGBTQIA+ person." (transgender, non-binary person)

Co-creation workshop

Proposed educational directions



"I feel maybe the communication could be better. So, we need more education and communication with the LGBTQIA+ people." (ph. student)

"I think more knowledge about hormones and more knowledge about fertility treatment would be good. Because I think those are the two things we see most commonly in LGBT people." (ph. technician)

References

1. https://www.womenscollegehospital.ca/the-progress-pride-flag-all-the-colours-of-the-rainbow/
2. https://innovation.sites.ku.dk/model/design-thinking/